

An Unpublished Two Funerary Cones of "sA-Imn"

نشر مخروطين جنازيين ل "سا-أمون"

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Abstract

The present article presents the study and publication of two funerary cones, registered under numbers 205 and 3575 in the AbulGud Museum storerooms in Luxor. Both funerary cones belong to a person who is named "sA-Imn" and has not been previously studied or published. Both cones were made of pottery, cylindrical in shape, and they have lost their pointed ends. Their round bases are stamped with a hieroglyphic inscription that is mentioning the name of the cone's owner and his title, as he bears the title "imy-r gs-pr n Hmt nTr", in addition to his wife's name and her title as she bears the title "nbt-pr", and he's a brother of Hapu-seneb from the reign of Hatshepsut, dated to the Eighteenth dynasty. Funerary cones are considered important source for the names and titles of high-ranking state officials and were typically placed in a frieze above the tomb entrance.

Keywords: AbulGud- Funerary cones- Thebes- Sa Amun- Overseer- gs-pr

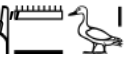
المخلص:

يتناول هذا البحث دراسة ونشر لمخروطين جنازيين فخاريين تحت أرقام 205، 3575 بمخازن ابي الجود المتحفية وهما لشخص يدعى "سا أمون"، ولم يتم التعرض لكليهما من قبل بالدراسة أو النشر، وهذان المخروطان من الفخار، أسطوانتي الشكل، فاقدتي النهاية المدببة، وعلى القاعدة المستديرة نص هيروغليفي يذكر اسم صاحب المخروط ولقبه إضافة إلى اسم زوجته ولقبها، وتعد المخاريط الجنازية أحد المصادر الهامة لأسماء كبار رجال الدولة وألقابهم في مصر القديمة، وكانت توضع عادة في إفريز أعلى مدخل المقبرة.

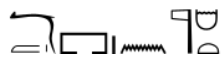
الكلمات الدالة: مخروط، مخاريط جنازية، طيبة، سا أمون، المشرف على gs-pr.

2. General Description

2.1. Cone No. 205 (Catalogue No. 22) (Fig. 2)

Owner of the Cone: "sA-Imn" 

Titles inscribed on the cone:

A)  Imy- r gs-pr n Hmt nTr "Overseer of the gs-pr of the God's wife"

Other names:

Hwy 

Title: nbt-pr "*Lady of the house*"

Material: baked clay

Colour: Reddish brown

Shape: Cylindrical

State of preservation: Museum Storeroom n.2 - AbulGud

Name of Registration: Albert Tadros

Number in the register: 205

Dimensions: Height 15.1 cm, Diameter of the inscribed base: 7.1 cm, Circle stamped frame: 5.9 cm.

Status: Missing parts of the rim of the round base and part of the body

Description:

The baked clay funerary cone, cylindrical in shape, which has been crudely truncated to approximately one thirds of its original length. The circular base is stamped with a circular inscription in raised relief. The inscription is legible and has survived intact. The upper right part of the cone suffered from erosion, while the left one suffered from traces of black soot.

The Hieroglyphic Inscriptions was stamped and arranged in three vertical columns with clear line in between, from left to right as follows:



Transliteration

1-Wsir imy r gs -pr n

2-Hmt- nTr {n} Imn sA imn mAa -xrw nbt

3-pr HwY mAat-xrw

Translation

1-"Osiris", overseer of the gs-pr of"

2-"the God's Wife {of Amun}, Sa Amun, justified, lady of"

3-"the house, HwY, justified".

2.2. Cone No. 3575 (Catalogue No. 23) (Figure 2 A-B).

Owner of the Cone: "sA-Imn 

Titles inscribed on the cone:

A) *Imy- r gs-pr n Hmt nTr* "Overseer of the gs-pr of the God's wife"

Other names:

HwY 

Title: *nbt-pr*  "Lady of the house"

Material: baked clay

Colour: Reddish brown

Shape: Cylindrical

State of preservation: Museum Storeroom n.2 - AbulGud

Name of Registration: The heirs of Zaki Muhareb

Number in the register: 3575

Dimensions: Height 7.1 cm, Diameter of the inscribed base: 6.7 cm.

Status: Missing parts of the rim of the round base and part of the body

Description:

The baked clay funerary cone, cylindrical in shape, which has been crudely truncated to approximately two thirds of its original length. The circular base is stamped with a circular inscription in raised relief. The inscription is legible although some of the text is obscured by surface damage. The clay appears to have been shaped by hand as the surface of the cone is very uneven and retains fingerprint impressions when the clay was handled before firing.

The Hieroglyphic Inscriptions were stamped and arranged in three vertical columns with clear line in between, as follows:



Transliteration

1-*Wsir imy r gs -pr n*

2-*Hmt- nTr {n} Imn sA imn mAa -xrw nbt*

3-*pr HwY mAaT-xrw*

Translation

1-*"Osiris", overseer of the gs-pr of"*

2-*"the God's Wife {of Amun}, Sa Amun, justified, lady of"*

3-*"the house, HwY, justified".*

3. Remarks on the cones inscriptions

The inscription which stamped on the cone was in raised, started from left to right, describing the deceased with the epithet of Osiris and not with the formula "*imAxy xr Wsir*" in contrast to most published cones in the *Corpus*.

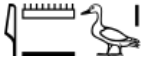
Then the title of the owner of the cone is "*imy-r gs-pr n Hmt nTr*", and his name came in the center of the second vertical column followed by the formula "*mAa xrw*".

HwY was his wife; she was entitled with the lady of the house "*nbt-pr*", her name followed by the formula "*mAat xrw*"

The name "Amun" that appears in the central column may also refer to the "*title*" and to the "*name*" of the person. This is called haplography. It occurs for example in cone D&M073, D&M074, D&M076, etc.

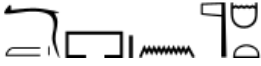
So in our cone case, the title could be "*imy r gs-pr n Hmt nTr {n} Imn*"

3.1. The names mentioned on the cones

Sa Amun 

Regarding the appearance of the name "Sa Amun" on other cones in the Corpus, it was not mentioned on any of the 611 cones listed. However, the name appeared in Zenihiro website on cone numbers (646/B.19-644/B.17)¹. Both of these cones bear a different title from the "Sa Amun" under study. Additionally, their discovery location differs, as both belong to the archaeological site of Tombos in Sudan².

3.2. The Titles:

imy r gs-pr n Hmt-nTr³ 

The first part of the title "imy- r gs-pr" is dating back to the Old Kingdom⁴ and notably common in the late Old Kingdom⁵, it may be translated as "overseer of troop-house (of workers)/ workplace"⁶, "overseer of royal production place"⁷ or "overseer of the half domain"⁸. Its prominence grew significantly, especially among mayors during the 12th Dynasty. The 13th Dynasty saw a sharp increase in the number of individuals that held this title, as court officials began to adopt it alongside the mayors. By the late 13th and early 17th Dynasties, this office was exceptionally well-documented, suggesting it held particular importance in both provincial and national administration. During the late Middle Kingdom, several distinct groups of people can be identified who held this significant position⁹.

gsw-prw facilities were spread throughout the country, which was evident from the occurrence of the title jmj-r³ gs-pr among the mayors. They supplied cattle, which were slaughtered there in their own slaughterhouses, but also various oils and ointments. gs-pr is therefore a term for production facilities/economic facilities, of

¹ <http://www.funerarycones.com/index.html> (last accessed 31/05/2025 21:00)

² The Tombos archaeological site is located near the Third Cataract on the Nile River in modern Sudan. Tombs found at the site indicate a historical period extending from the New Kingdom (mid-18th Dynasty) to the Napatan Kingdom. It also documents the extent of connection and intermingling between Egyptian colonists and local Nubians during sociopolitical changes in the region. <https://tombos.org> (Last accessed 31/05/2025 21:30)

³ Al-Ayedi, Abdul Rahman. *Index of Egyptian administrative, religious and military titles of the New Kingdom*. Vol. 2. Obelisk Publications, 2006. p. 173 (521).

⁴ Murray, Margaret A. *Index of Names & Titles of The Old Kingdom*. London, 1908, pl. XXIV-XXV.

⁵ Grajetzki, Wolfram. *Notes on administration in the Second Intermediate Period*. Vol. 192. 2010, p. 201.

⁶ Jones, Dilwyn. *An Index of Ancient Egyptian Titles, Epithets and Phrases of the Old Kingdom Volumes I : A completely updated and revised edition of Murray's Index of 1908 including an analysis of all new material published to date*. BAR Publishing, 2000. p. 269 (969).

⁷ Grajetzki, Wolfram. *Court Officials of the Egyptian Middle Kingdom*, 2009, p. 38

⁸ Quirke, Stephen. *Titles. and Bureaux of Egypt 1850-1700 BC*, London, 2004, p. 115

⁹ Grajetzki. *Notes on administration in the Second Intermediate Period*. p. 201

which there were several in the provinces and at least one at the court or in the residence itself¹⁰. *jmj-r gs-pr n Hmt nTr* thus refers to the head of a (royal) economic facility.

The funerary cone being studied isn't the only one with an "*overseer of the half-domain*" title. Other cones listed in the Corpus show interesting variations of this role, highlighting different affiliations for the '*half-domain*':

- Amenhotep's cone (no. 268) bears the title "*imy-r gs-pr n Hmt nTr*" ("*overseer of the half-domain of the God's Wife*"). This suggests his responsibilities were tied to the estates or administration of the God's Wife.
- Sa Anum-iah's cone (no. 556) and Ray's cone (no. 122) both simply have the title "*imy-r gs-pr*" ("*overseer of the half-domain*").
- Ihy's cone (no. 195) features the title "*imy-r gs-pr n Hmt-nswt*" ("*overseer of the half-domain of the King's Wife*"). This indicates a direct association with the King's Wife's properties or administration.

These examples from the Corpus are important for understanding the specific administrative roles and royal or divine connections of individuals holding variations of the "*overseer of the half-domain*" title.

Hmt nTr  :

Three hieroglyphic signs spell the Egyptian title *Hmt nTr*, a title commonly translated into English as "*God's Wife*". Prior to the Eighteenth dynasty, the title of "*God's Wife*" is attested only in an abbreviated form, , without a reference to any particular deity. During the Middle Kingdom, two women, both non-royal, held this abbreviated form of the title, and it is possible that both were priestesses¹¹.

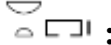
At first, the title was held by women who were members of the royal family by birth, so that the holders before the sole rule of Thutmose III were all also king's daughters. During the sole rule of Thutmose III to the reign of Thutmose IV, three of the holders were not members of the royal family by birth, but only by '*marriage*', suggesting a possible shift of emphasis from royal birth to simple membership of the royal family. After this, the title disappears from the royal family until the beginning of the 19th dynasty.¹²

¹⁰ Grajetzki. *Notes on administration in the Second Intermediate Period*. p. 202.

¹¹ Ayad, Mariam F. *God's Wife, God's Servant: The God's Wife of Amun (ca. 740–525 BC)*. Routledge, 2009, p. 3-4

¹² Robins, Gay. *The God's Wife of Amun in the 18th Dynasty in Egypt*. Croom Helm, 1983, p. 71

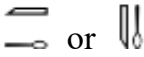
From at least the tenure of Ahmose-Nefretari onward there existed an economic entity associated with the office of god's wife, and this was the *pr hmt ntr*, literally "The house/estate of the god's wife", referred to in account documents, even in the 18th Dynasty, as *pr dw3t*, "*the house of the adoratrice*". The estate (*pr dw3t*) and the office holders (*Hmt ntr/dw3t ntr*) were not identical, and they could hold property separately. For example, a jar seal of the New Kingdom found in the workmen's village of Deir el Medina was labeled: "[*product name missing*] of the god's wife of the house of the adoratrice". This prepares us for the fact that god's wives held their own estates supported by their personal property and also planned for future funerary cults out of these independent holdings. However, the large administration associated with the god's wife, was, in the 18th Dynasty, headed by the "*steward of the god's wife*", and this continued to be the case later, although the office was then more commonly referred to as that of the "*divine adoratrice*"¹³.

nbt pr¹⁴  :

The title "*Lady of the House*" is first attested in the Middle Kingdom and was used continually through the Ptolemaic Period¹⁵, even it had limited attestations during the Old Kingdom¹⁶

Commonly held by married women¹⁷, the title entailed a range of responsibilities within large households, including supervising weaving workshops, coordinating food provisions, producing clothing, and maintaining fruit and vegetable gardens¹⁸.

mAa xrw

The expression mAa xrw was written fully as  , and abbreviated as  or  a formula commonly translated into English as "*true of voice*"¹⁹ or "to

¹³ Bryan, Betsy. "Property and the Gods Wives of Amun." *Women and property in ancient Near Eastern and Mediterranean societies*, 2003, p. 2.

¹⁴ Erman, Adolf, and Hermann Grapow. *Wörterbuch der Aegyptischen Sprache*. Berlin: Akademie-Verlag, 1982, p. 232.

¹⁵ Li, Jean. *Elite Theban women of the eighth-sixth centuries BCE in Egypt: Identity, status and mortuary practice*. University of California, Berkeley, 2010, p. 28.

¹⁶ Farouk, May. Some Observations on Status of Ancient Egyptian Women up to the End of the Middle Kingdom. *Journal of the Faculty of Tourism and Hotels-University of Sadat City*, Vol. 9 Issue (1/3), June 2025, 105-126., p. 119.

¹⁷ Ward, William A. *Essays on feminine titles of the Middle Kingdom and related subjects*. 1986, p. 8.

¹⁸ Farouk, May. Some Observations on Status of Ancient Egyptian Women up to the End of the Middle Kingdom. p. 119.

¹⁹ Gardiner, Alan. 1957. *Egyptian grammar being an introduction to the study of hieroglyphs*. 3rd ed. London: Oxford University Press, p. 50 (§55)

be justified", it was added to the name of every deceased person from the middle kingdom²⁰.

In the New Kingdom, the epithet is occasionally placed after the names of the living, probably as a wish for the afterlife. In the vicinity of Osiris, priests and pilgrims receive the epithet, probably in imitation of their god. For kings, the epithet also seems to have another meaning, which derives directly from the Horus myth. When used for the living king, it means "the victorious, the right, and the legitimate."²¹

4. Discussion and Dating:

This funerary cone can be confidently dated to the New Kingdom. This is based on two key pieces of historical evidence: the title "imy-r gs-pr n Hmt nTr" ("overseer of the estate the God's wife") and the fact that inscribed fired clay funerary cones like this one became common during that period.

Possible kinship to " Hpw snb ": The Turin Museum holds a statue of " Hpw snb " (No. 3061) ". While "Sa Hpw snb that identifies a "Sa Amun" as a brother of " ²²

 carries a different title—"sS sDAw-nTr tpi {n} Imn" ("scribe of the secrets of the god, first of Amun")²³—it's common for high-ranking individuals to hold multiple titles throughout their careers, While concurring with this attribution²⁴

Another mention of "Sa Amun" is on the lower part of a coffin found by Mond in the well of the court of TT 68. But this time with the title "TAy"  without ensuring the title²⁵.

The varying titles (imy-r gs-pr, sS sDAw-nTr tpi {n} Imn, and TAy) don't contradict the idea that they all refer to the same person, "Sa Amun". This practice of accumulating diverse titles is well-documented in ancient Egypt, as seen with figures like Dwawneheh (TT 125) and Ahmose (TT 224), both of whom held the imy-r gs-pr title among others.

Osiris noted that viziers often held the "imy-r gs-pr" title. Since managing the "half domain" was one of the vizier's responsibilities, this connection underscored the importance of the "imy-r gs-pr" designation.

²⁰ Rudolf, Anthes. "The Original Meaning of MAa xrw." *Journal of Near Eastern Studies* 13 (1954): 21-51.

²¹ Helck, Wolfgang, Eberhard Otto, and Wolfhart Westendorf, eds. *Lexikon der Ägyptologie*. Vol. 3. Otto Harrassowitz Verlag, 1975, pp. 1107-1110.

²² Sethe, Kurt. *Urkunden des ägyptischen Altertums*, Band IV, Urkunden der 18. Dynastie, 1906, p. 470 (17).

²³ Eichler, Selke Susan. Die Verwaltung des. ",Hauses des Amun "in der 18." *Dynastie*, BSAK 7. 2000, p. 312 (471)

²⁴ Whale, Sheila. "The Family in the Eighteenth Dynasty of Egypt." *ACES*. Vol. 1. 1989., 27.

²⁵ Collins, Lydia. "The private tombs of Thebes: excavations by Sir Robert Mond 1905 and 1906." *The Journal of Egyptian Archaeology* 62.1, 1976,: pp. 36-37.

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Taking all this evidence into account, we can firmly place this funerary cone in the Eighteenth Dynasty.

Conclusion:

- The two particular funerary cones stand out as unique, with no exact parallel found in major published sources like *The Corpus* or other collections.
- The owner of both cones is called "Sa Amun", bearing the title "imy-r gs-pr n Hmt nTr" or "imy-r gs-pr n Hmt nTr {n}Imn", his wife is called HwY, with the title "nbt-pr", and he's a brother of HpW snb from the reign of Hatshepsut, Eighteenth dynasty.
- TT 227 may be suggested to be the tomb of "Sa Amun" the owner of the cones.
- 18th dynasty is the precise date of the cone in the light of the relation with HpW snb has been considered his optional brother.

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- 2) <https://tombos.org>

Figures

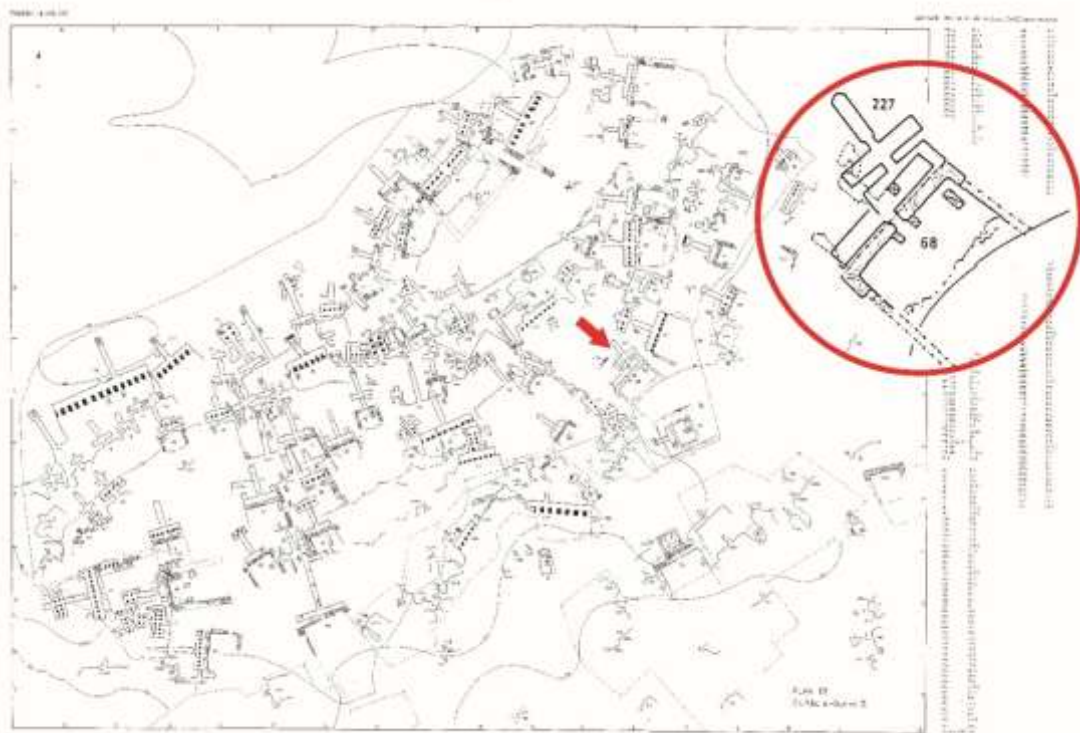


Fig. 1. A plan of Theban tombs of Sheikh Abd el-Qurna, and TT 227 after Kampp 1996.



Fig. 2 An image and drawing of Cone n. 22, By Ahmed Elnasseh



Fig. 3a. An image of Cone n. 23, By Ahmed Elnasseh

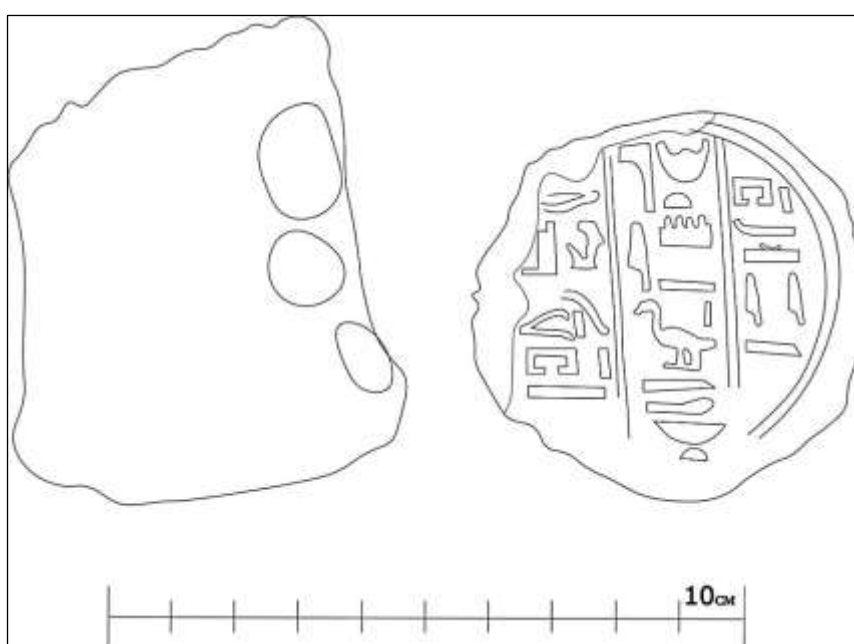


Fig. 3b. A Drawing of Cone n. 23, By Ahmed Elnasseh